

1 The other ACSAC formats

Everything below is for ACSAC 2026, held 7 to 11 December 2026 in Los Angeles. Venue policies are scoped to a year and this file is not valid for another one. Sources and access dates are at the end.

The refereed paper track and the 750 word response are covered elsewhere in these notes. This section covers the three other routes into the conference: posters and works in progress, panels, and case studies. Each has a different deadline, a different audience, and a different thing it publishes.

1.1 Posters and works in progress

Dates. “Deadline: September 19 (23:59 Anywhere on Earth).” Notification is “rolling.”

Length and format. “Poster proposals should be at most 2 pages, including references.” Submissions use “the 2-column IEEE template available at ieee.org/conferences/publishing/templates.html.”

Anonymity. The opposite of the paper track. “Poster proposals are not anonymous, so please make sure you include author information (name, affiliation, country) in your proposal.”

What it is for. The session “provides an opportunity for researchers and practitioners to present their new and innovative preliminary results and latest works-in-progress in an informal, interactive setting.” The stated benefit to the presenter is feedback at an early stage rather than a publication.

Cost and obligation. “If your proposal is accepted, a presenter is required to register, pay, and attend the conference.” The presenter must set up beforehand and stand with the poster for about 75 minutes. One concession: “accepted Poster authors do not need to pay the ‘Publication Surcharge’ that is requested of authors of accepted technical papers.”

What the two page limit implies. Two pages including references is not a short paper. It holds the objective, what has been done, and what comes next, and nothing else. The Better Poster structure in the talks section applies to the board itself rather than to this proposal.

1.2 Panels

The panel track runs on a much earlier schedule than the others, and the schedule is the thing most likely to be missed.

Dates. “Abstract Deadline: July 8.” “Notification: July 15.” “Complete Panel Details: August 20.” A final description, the panelists and their affiliations, and one paragraph statements from each panelist are due by 1 September.

Length. The proposal is “no longer than one page,” carrying a title, the moderator, the potential panelists, and “a brief one or two paragraph description.”

What the chair wants. Panels should “encourage audience participation and focus on the sharp edges of a new and emerging topic where there is controversy or where there are widely varying positions.”

That sentence is the selection criterion. A panel proposed around a topic where the panelists agree is proposing a tutorial. The proposal has to name the disagreement and say who holds which position.

Submission. By email to the panels address, with the moderator’s name and address included.

1.3 Case studies

Dates. “Deadline: September 22.” “Notification: October 6.”

What it is. “The Case Studies in Applied Security Track is a critical part of the technical conference. It is an opportunity for professionals to share information that is current without writing a detailed technical paper.” The track is “open to anyone in the community such as vendors, network providers, systems integrators, government civil/federal/military programs or users across the spectrum of computer security applications.”

What is submitted. Not a paper. “Submit a short paragraph describing your proposed presentation to the Case Studies Chair. This paragraph should indicate how the case study is important and relevant to today’s problems in computer security.” The submission carries the presenter’s name and affiliation, address, phone number, short biography, title, and abstract.

What gets published. “While the Case Studies will not be included in the Proceedings, the presentations will be posted to the ACSAC site following the conference.” A release is signed, and materials must not be marked restricted, proprietary, or company confidential.

What a good one looks like, quoted. It “Describes an application of security concepts or technologies used in a new way.” It “Describes a security architecture.” It “Displays a clear understanding of the relevance of this presentation to related efforts and products, including references as appropriate.” It “Is delivered without accompanying written material.” It “Is timely (current topics).”

What to avoid, quoted. “Presentations that could be used essentially unchanged as a sales or marketing pitches.” “Presentations that have been delivered before in a public forum, as a conference paper, magazine article, journal article, or book chapter.”

Award. “Yes! The committee will be awarding the ‘ACSAC Best Case Study Award’ at the conference.”

Obligation. Presenters “are required to register, pay, and attend the conference,” with reduced student registration and no exemption for organizers.

1.4 What the paper track hints say that the others do not

Two items from the Paper Hints and Notes page apply beyond the paper track and are worth having in one place.

The track redirection is official. “Papers which are not appropriate for the refereed papers track may be appropriate for the ‘case studies’ track. Another alternative is to assemble a group of people with diverse ideas on the topic you wish to discuss and submit a panel proposal.” The conference states the fallback route rather than leaving authors to infer it.

Anonymizing the artifact repository is the author’s job, and it is specified. “When preparing the artifacts repository for initial inclusion in the paper submission form . . . please take extra care to not include authors’ information in the repository or artifacts content, so as not to break the anonymity of the paper submission.” The page names services such as GitFront and Anonymous GitHub, and adds that “authors should make sure to use account names and repository

names that do not identify the authors, and should remove any comments/text in the repository that may directly identify the authors or the authors’ institution.”

Two further items from the same page. Do not include a copyright notice, because it interferes with making copies for reviewers and with anonymization. And accepted submissions “may be assigned a member of the program committee to act as its shepherd through the preparation of the final paper,” with that member acting “as a conduit for feedback from the committee to the authors.”

1.5 The three deadlines in order

Panels close first and by a wide margin. July 8 for the abstract, against September 19 for posters and September 22 for case studies. A panel is a decision made in spring, not in autumn.

1.6 Sources

- *Call for Posters and Works-in-Progress*, ACSAC 2026, acsac.org/2026/submissions/posters/. Read as a web page, 26 August 2026.
- *Call for Panels*, ACSAC 2026, acsac.org/2026/submissions/panels/. Read as a web page, 26 August 2026.
- *Call for Case Studies*, ACSAC 2026. Read in full from the local capture at `Submissions/2_Aug25th_May26th_ACSAC2026/Case Study.pdf`, text extracted with a converter.
- *Paper Hints and Notes*, ACSAC 2026. Read in full from the local capture in the same folder.
- Also in that folder and not used here: the main call for papers, *What Makes a Good Paper*, the artifact review guide, and the 2025 welcome and awards slides.

Verification status. The poster and panel pages were read once each, on one route. The case study and hints documents were read from local captures whose own capture date is not recorded in the file. Before relying on any date above, open the page again. Venue pages change quietly between years and these are dates rather than arguments.